

connected device makers like Amazon and Samsung.

Nest already had Thread as a networking protocol for connected devices. But to persuade manufacturers to deploy the protocol on their devices, the company has now open sourced its existing version and released it as a new model called OpenThread.

"Thread makes it possible for devices to simply, securely, and reliably connect to each other and to the cloud," said Greg Hu, head of the Nest platform, in a statement. "And because Thread is an IPv6 networking protocol built on open standards, millions of existing 802.15.4 wireless devices on the market can be easily updated to run it," he added.

In addition to Nest Labs, tech giants like ARM, Atmel, Qualcomm and Texas Instruments will contribute to OpenThread. The protocol will also be able to run Thread-capable radios and corresponding development kits from NXP Semiconductors and Silicon Labs. Moreover, it is broadly expected to accelerate the deployment of the existing Thread and lead to a 'major networking technology standard' for connected devices.



"OpenThread allows us to work with other like-minded corporations and individuals to deliver a best-in-class implementation of Thread that can be widely used for the advancement of a connected and secure home," said Jeffery Torrance, vice president of business development, Qualcomm.

OpenThread can initially be accessed through GitHub. Users can submit their Pull Requests and access its sample code as well as file their issues directly on GitHub or Nest's discussion forum.

Based in Palo Alto, California, Nest isn't new to the world of IoT. The company was co-founded as an enterprise back in 2012 by former Apple engineers. But in January 2014, it was acquired by Google.

Nest is one of the early enablers of connected devices, and is perhaps among the tech companies that are set to bring the concept of IoT closer to the open source field.

The adoption of the open source model might help Nest enhance its existing partner base. However, it would need to develop a strong community to make the new offering successful.

Apple's CareKit now available as an open source framework

After officially announcing the launch of CareKit in March, Apple has now open sourced it. The new development is aimed at enabling developers to build new healthcare apps for iPhone and iPad devices.

Red Hat Enterprise Linux (RHEL) 6.8 brings Libreswan VPN protocol implementation

Red Hat has released RHEL 6.8, which is aimed at enhancing security through the all-new Libreswan VPN implementation.

"RHEL 6.8 continues to demonstrate Red

Hat's commitment to our customers' many mission-critical deployments by delivering a proven foundation for the applications and



systems that power the modern enterprise," said Jim Totton, vice president and general manager, platform business unit, Red Hat, in a statement.

Replacing the existing Openswan, the latest RHEL version comes with Libreswan offering the most recent advances in VPN security. The previous identity management client code (SSSD) has also received new capabilities to deliver faster client-side performance and simpler management. There is simplified support for Adcli, and SSSD now supports user authentication via smart cards for both system login and related functions.

Apart from the major new additions, system archiving tool Relax-and-Recover has been included in RHEL 6.8 to streamline systems administration. This new tool offers sys admins the capability to create local backups in an ISO format. Notably, the backup files can be centrally archived and replicated remotely to enable simplified disaster recovery operations.

The new RHEL comes preloaded with an enhanced Yum tool to simplify the addition of packages. It adds an intelligence layer to the process of locating packages.

Red Hat has added the Dmstats program to display and manage I/O statistics for user-defined regions using the device-mapper driver. Besides, there is expanded XFS filesystem support to let you use the scalable file system add-on for adding up to 300TB of data.

"With enhancements to security features and management, RHEL 6.8 remains a solid, proven base for modern enterprise IT operations," Totton added.